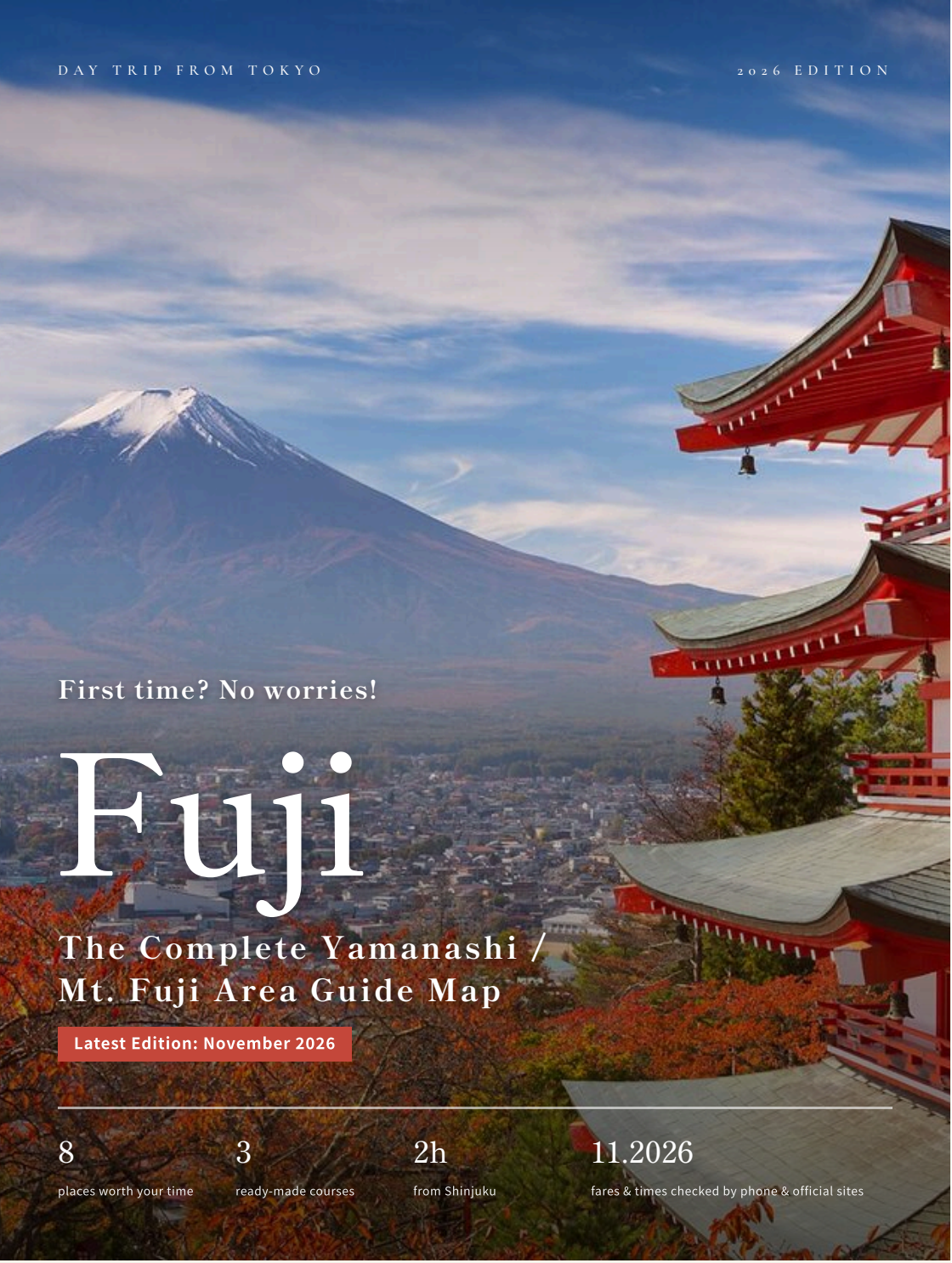


First time? No worries!

# Fuji

## The Complete Yamanashi / Mt. Fuji Area Guide Map

**Latest Edition: November 2026**

| 8 | 3 | 2h | 11.2026 |
|---|---|---|---|
| places worth your time | ready-made courses | from Shinjuku | fares & times checked by phone & official sites |

*Welcome*

# Before you start

Every fare, timetable and opening time in this guide was checked in November 2026 on official websites or by phone with the companies that run them. Where we used anything else, we say so.

⚠ Prices and times in Japan do change, often in spring (when timetables are revised) or when taxes or fuel costs change. **Before you travel, check the official websites** named in each chapter, especially for trains, buses and opening days.

## Contents *Contents*




1 **Before You Go** — When Mt. Fuji is visible · if it's hiding — 05



2 **Getting There from Tokyo** — Train · highway bus · local sightseeing buses — 07



3 **8 Places Worth Your Time** — Access · time needed · cost — 16



4 **Ready-Made Courses** — First visit · photographers · rainy day — 25



5 **Local Food** — Hoto · Yoshida udon — 29



6 **Good to Know** — Crowds · manners · phrases · packing — 30

Know Before You Go 03 · Course Finder 04 · Book & Navigate (QR) 32 · Quick Map 34


This is an independent travel guide, not connected with any company or place in it.

# Know before you go

The points that most often catch travelers out, and that quick online answers often get wrong or leave out. We checked each one with the operators themselves in November 2026.

| | What to know | Ch. |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Fuji Excursion train: board Cars 1–3 only.** The other cars go somewhere else. | 2 |
| 2 | **Japan Rail Pass covers Shinjuku–Otsuki only.** Otsuki to Kawaguchiko costs ¥1,770 extra (fare + express fee). Children's express fee on this section is ¥400. | 2 |
| 3 | **Miss your highway bus and the ticket is void.** No later bus, no refund. Change or cancel before departure. | 2 |
| 4 | **No big suitcases on the sightseeing buses.** Use the coin lockers right outside Kawaguchiko Station's ticket gates (¥700–1,200). | 2 |
| 5 | **Red Line only? Don't buy the 1-Day Pass.** Single tickets are cheaper. Buy it if you ride the Green or Blue Line. | 2 |
| 6 | **Chureito Pagoda is about 25 minutes on foot from Shimoyoshida Station,** including 398 steps. | 3 |
| 7 | **Oshino Hakkai: you may touch the water, but never throw coins in.** | 3 |
| 8 | **The ¥1,000-bill view at Lake Motosu is about 1 hour on foot from the bus stop.** Buses run about once an hour; last bus back 16:45. | 3 |
| 9 | **Fuji-Q Highland has closing days, and its Ferris wheel is closed until January 31, 2027.** | 3 |
| 10 | **Mt. Fuji is often hidden in summer.** In 2025 the whole mountain was visible at 8 a.m. on only 2 days in June. | 1 |
| 11 | **Tattoos:** Fuji Choubou no Yu Yurari says no; Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko says yes. | 4 |
| 12 | **The Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum is closed on Tuesdays and Wednesdays.** | 4 |

### FROM THE AUTHOR

I made this guide because the information on getting to Mt. Fuji is spread across dozens of Japanese websites, and quick online answers are often out of date or wrong. The text was written with the help of AI tools, but I checked every fare, timetable and opening time myself on official websites and by phone with the railway and bus companies, museums, hot springs and tourist offices, in November 2026. **— Tama**

*Course Finder*

# Start! Find Your Course

Answer from the top and follow the arrows to find your perfect day.

✔ The night before, check a live camera (Chapter 1)…

- **A.** Mt. Fuji looks clear
- **B.** Cloudy or rainy



COURSE C
### Rainy Day
Museums, hoto, day-trip hot spring
→ Chapter 4

✔ What do you want most?

- **A.** The famous photo
- **B.** Easy views & good food
- **C.** A special Fuji view

✔ The 7:30 Fuji Excursion from Shinjuku?

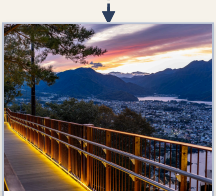
- **A.** I can make it
- **B.** Too early for me

✔ Walk about 1 hour each way from the bus stop?

- **A.** No problem
- **B.** I'd rather not



COURSE B
### Photo Lover's Day
Chureito Pagoda before the crowds, Oishi Park, Nenba



COURSE A
### Relaxed Day
Ropeway, hoto lunch, Oishi Park
→ Chapter 4



LAKE MOTOSU
### The ¥1,000 bill view
About 3 hours by bus and on foot
→ Chapter 3 · ⑧



5TH STATION
### Halfway up Mt. Fuji
Direct bus, about 1 hour. Only when the road is open

**Have a tattoo?** For a hot spring, choose Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko (tattoos OK).

**Japan Rail Pass?** It covers Shinjuku–Otsuki only. See Chapter 2.

**June to August?** Mt. Fuji is often hidden. Keep Course C ready.

**Big suitcase?** Leave it in a locker just outside Kawaguchiko Station's ticket gates.



CHAPTER

# 01

# Before You Go

One goal: when you go from Tokyo to see Mt. Fuji on a day trip, don't waste your time on confusing transport or bad timing. Every place in this guide is in the Fuji Five Lakes area (Yamanashi), the easiest part of Mt. Fuji to reach from Tokyo.

## What if Mt. Fuji is hidden? *If Fuji is hiding*

1. **Check a live camera the night before and that morning**
   For example, Fuji Motosuko Resort (near Lake Motosu) links to free YouTube live cameras from its official website. No sign-up. Search "Fuji Motosuko Resort live camera".

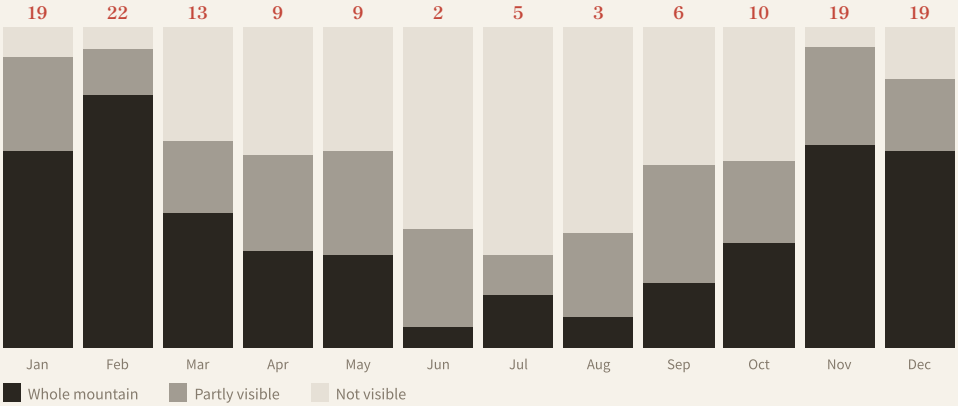
2. **Keep your dates flexible**
   If you are in Tokyo for several days, keep your Fuji day movable and pick the clearest one.

3. **Use the rainy-day plan**
   Course C in Chapter 4: food, a hot spring and museums.

*When to Go*

# Winter: 2 days in 3. Summer: a few days a month.

Mt. Fuji hides behind clouds far more often than most visitors expect. Here are the days each month when the whole mountain was visible — the best season is clear at a glance.




Numbers above the bars = days the whole mountain was visible. Fuji City (Shizuoka) "Mt. Fuji observation record" 2025, observed every morning at 8 a.m. from City Hall.

**Nov–Feb**
Best bet. The whole mountain was visible about 2 days in 3.

**Mar–May · Sep–Oct**
Whole mountain visible on 6–13 days a month.

**Jun–Aug**
Whole mountain visible on only a few days a month.

NOTE

This is one year's record, seen from the Shizuoka side. The Fuji Five Lakes area can differ. Always check a live camera before you go.



CHAPTER

# 02 Getting There from Tokyo

*Train or Bus?*

## Train or bus?

### Train (Fuji Excursion)

**1:55** approx. **¥4,200**

✓ Rarely delayed
✓ More legroom, you can walk around
× Pricier · only 4 round trips a day

Best for: tight schedules, the trip back on busy days

*vs*

### Highway bus

**1:45** approx. **¥2,000+**

✓ Cheaper · many departures
✓ Seat belts · toilet on board
× Depends on traffic

Best for: budget travelers, weekday trips

OUR PICK

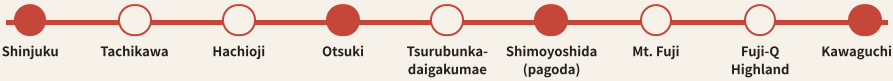
Highway buses can be late when roads are busy. If you must be back in Tokyo by a set time, **take the train back**.

*A — By Train*

# The Fuji Excursion: Shinjuku to the lake, no change.

| Shinjuku → Kawaguchiko | Adult one way | Trains | Tickets on sale |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1:54–1:58** | **¥4,200** | **4 a day** | **1 month** |
| | fare ¥2,580 + express ¥1,620 | +1 on some days | before, from 10 a.m. |

## Stops *Stops*




To Shimoyoshida (nearest station to the pagoda): ¥4,010. No unreserved seats: buy a reserved seat or a "seat-unspecified" ticket.

**Board Cars 1–3 only.** The Fuji Excursion has just 3 cars. Between Shinjuku and Otsuki it is coupled to another express (Azusa or Kaiji). In any other car you will end up somewhere else.

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | ⋯ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Fuji Excursion → Kawaguchiko — Azusa / Kaiji (split at Otsuki, goes elsewhere)

### How to book

On the English site for overseas visitors, "JR-EAST Train Reservation", or on Eki-net.

### Book morning trains early

Morning trains can be almost full, even on weekdays.

## Which side for Mt. Fuji? *Which side?*

On the Fujikyu section (Otsuki → Kawaguchiko) the view switches sides, so there is no single best side.

| Otsuki → Gekkoji | Gekkoji → Mt. Fuji Sta. | Mt. Fuji → Kawaguchiko |
|---|---|---|
| Left | Right | Left |

Facing the direction of travel; the opposite on the way back. Section lengths approximate. (Fujikyu Railway official Q&A and JR East official site, November 2026.)

*Timetable*

# Weekday timetable

From March 14, 2026 · Fujikyu Railway official. Weekend times differ. Always check the latest timetable before booking.

## Out · To Kawaguchiko

| Train | Shinjuku | Kawaguchiko |
|---|---|---|
| Fuji Excursion 3 | 7:30 | 9:28 |
| Fuji Excursion 7 | 8:30 | 10:26 |
| Fuji Excursion 11 | 9:30 | 11:28 |
| Fuji Excursion 15 | 10:30 | 12:24 |

## Back · To Tokyo

| Train | Kawaguchiko | Shinjuku |
|---|---|---|
| Fuji Excursion 32 | 14:08 | 16:08 |
| Fuji Excursion 36 | 14:58 | 16:59 |
| Fuji Excursion 44 | 16:48 | 18:48 |
| Fuji Excursion 48 | 17:41 | 19:48 |




Kawaguchiko Station: a Fuji Excursion (left) and a Fujikyu Railway train.

# If you have a rail pass

### Japan Rail Pass (nationwide)

It covers **Shinjuku–Otsuki only**. Otsuki–Kawaguchiko (Fujikyu Railway) costs extra.

| From Otsuki | Fare | Express fee | Total (one way) |
|---|---|---|---|
| to Kawaguchiko | 1,170 | 600 | **1,770** |
| to Shimoyoshida (pagoda) | 980 | 600 | **1,580** |

Children pay half the fare (Otsuki–Kawaguchiko ¥590) and a ¥400 express fee. Suica/PASMO work and are slightly cheaper (Otsuki–Kawaguchiko ¥1,161). The Fujikyu express fee is ¥600 whether you buy before boarding or on the train; if you are short of time, pay the difference at your exit station. (Official fare tables; confirmed by phone with Fujikyu call center, November 2, 2026.)

### JR Tokyo Wide Pass (3 days)

For holders of non-Japanese passports only. **It covers the whole Fujikyu Railway**, so the Fuji Excursion is covered all the way from Shinjuku to Kawaguchiko.

- Before boarding, get a **free reserved seat** at a JR ticket machine or office; otherwise you may only use empty seats
- Fujikyu's own Fujisan Limited Express and Fujisan View Express reserved seats, and the Fuji Tozan Densha, cost extra
- Carry your original passport while using it

JR East official conditions, as of March 2026

## If the train is full *Plan B*




About 20 minutes longer, and the Fujikyu section can't be booked on Eki-net. Fujikyu fare ¥1,170, plus an express fee if you take Fujikyu's own expresses:

| Otsuki–Kawaguchiko | Express fee | Seat |
|---|---|---|
| Fujikyu express (basic) | **400** | — |
| Fujisan View Express Car 2 | +200 | Reserved |
| Fujisan View Express Car 1 | +900 | Premium car |
| Fujisan Ltd. Express Cars 1–2 | +200 | Reserved |

Note: these fees are different from the Fuji Excursion's ¥600. (Fujikyu Railway official fare table, November 2026.)




*B — By Highway Bus*

# Busta Shinjuku to Kawaguchiko Station.

| To Kawaguchiko | Adult one way | Departures | No rest stop |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1:45** | **¥2,000–2,200** | **10–60 min** | **Toilet** |
| longer in traffic | cheaper online | apart | on board |

It also stops at Fuji-Q Highland (about 1h40, same fare) and continues to Oshino Hakkai and Lake Yamanaka. In summer some buses go up to Mt. Fuji's 5th Station. No round-trip discount. All seats are reserved; choose window or aisle when booking. Women-only seats available.

### Buying tickets

On sale 1 month ahead from 10 a.m. Online by credit card, or at the counters at Busta Shinjuku, Fuji-Q Highland, Kawaguchiko Station and Mt. Fuji Station. Online bookings not paid by the deadline are cancelled automatically.

### Cancelling

Free until the bus leaves except a ¥110 fee per one-way ticket (may vary). Cancel online if you bought online, at a counter if you bought there. You can cancel one leg of a round trip.

### If you miss the bus

Buses leave exactly on time. Once it has left, your ticket is void: no later bus, no refund. If you'll be late, change or cancel **before** departure.

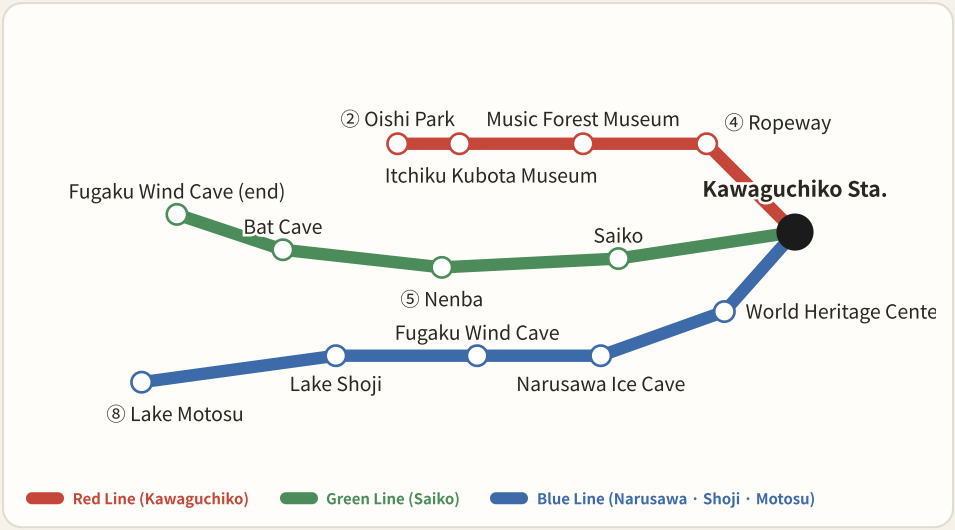
### Luggage & children

One suitcase per person goes free in the hold. Children of elementary-school age and under pay half. One preschool child per adult rides free on your lap.

English help: main booking sites (e.g. FUJIYAMA CONNECT) work in English, Chinese and Korean; some staff at the Kawaguchiko and Mt. Fuji Station counters speak English or Chinese. Fujikyu call center 0570-022956. (Highway Bus.com and Fujikyu Bus official FAQ, November 2026.)

# Getting around: three colored loop buses.

Sightseeing buses loop around the lakes from Kawaguchiko Station. Remember the color of the line you need and you won't get lost.




Not to scale. Lake Shoji's stop is "Kodaki Fuji View Point"; Oishi Park's is "Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center".

| Line | Main stops | Places in this guide |
|---|---|---|
| Red | Ropeway ("Yuransen · Ropeway Iriguchi"), Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum, Itchiku Kubota Art Museum, Oishi Park ("Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center") | ②④ |
| Green | Saiko, Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba, Saiko Bat Cave, Fugaku Wind Cave (end) | ⑤ |
| Blue | Mt. Fuji World Heritage Center, Narusawa Ice Cave, Fugaku Wind Cave, Lake Shoji, Lake Motosu | ⑧ |

ⓘ Chureito Pagoda (①) and Oshino Hakkai (③) are not on these loop buses. See Chapter 3 for how to get there.

*Bus Passes*

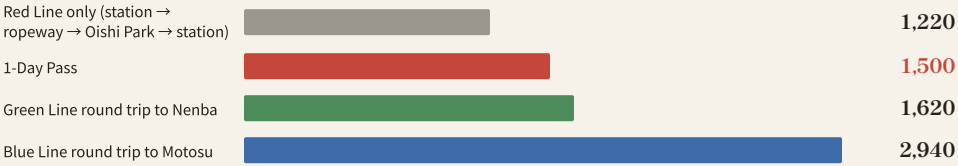
# Is a bus pass worth it?

"Kawaguchiko · Saiko · Motosuko Sightseeing Coupon": unlimited rides on all three lines plus regular route buses in the area (not the Shibazakura shuttle).

| Pass | Adult (junior high+) | Child (elementary) |
|---|---|---|
| 1-Day Pass | 1,500 | 750 |
| 2-Day Pass | 2,000 | 1,000 |
| 2-Day Pass + ropeway round trip + boat (or one-way boat to Oishi Park) | 3,300 | 1,650 |

Buy at the bus ticket office at Kawaguchiko Station or online (Fujikyu's FUJIYAMA CONNECT, until noon on the day). The 2-Day Pass runs for 2 days from the date you choose. Online purchases: free cancellation until the day before, full charge on the day.

## What do single tickets cost? *Pay as you go*




VERDICT

**Red Line only? Single tickets are cheaper.** If you ride the Green or Blue Line, buy the 1-Day Pass.

## Fares by line (adult, ¥) *Fares*

| Line | From Kawaguchiko Station to | Fare |
|---|---|---|
| Red | Ropeway | 180 |
| | Itchiku Kubota Art Museum | 440 |
| | Oishi Park (Natural Living Center) · ropeway→Oishi Park ¥470 | 570 |
| Green | Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba | 810 |
| Blue | Narusawa Ice Cave | 740 |
| | Fugaku Wind Cave | 770 |
| | Lake Motosu Tourist Info Center / "Motosuko" stop | 1,470 |

Fujikyu Bus official site, FUJIYAMA CONNECT and official fare table, November 2026. "Motosuko" stop confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 2, 2026.

*2-Day Passport*

# Mt. FUJI Passport

Two days of unlimited rides on the Red, Green and Blue Lines, the "Fujikko-go" (Fujiyoshida · Oshino Hakkai · Lake Yamanaka), the World Heritage Loop Bus, route buses in the Five Lakes area, and the Fujikyu Railway. Discounts at sights too.

| Pass | Fujikyu Railway section | Adult | Child |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mt. FUJI Passport | Shimoyoshida–Kawaguchiko | 3,300 | 1,660 |
| Mt. FUJI Passport "Train Set" | Otsuki–Kawaguchiko (whole line) | 4,700 | 2,360 |

Express trains need an express ticket; the Fuji Tozan Densha needs a seat ticket. Highway buses and 5th Station buses are not included. Sold at Fujikyu Bus counters at Mt. Fuji and Kawaguchiko stations (Train Set also at the Fujikyu counter at Otsuki) and as a mobile ticket. No refunds once used. (Fujikyu Railway official site, November 2026.)

JR PASS HOLDERS

Otsuki–Kawaguchiko is ¥1,170 one way (¥2,340 return). If you will ride the loop buses too, the "Train Set" (¥4,700) covers both.

## Good to know on the loop buses *Good to know*

### IC cards OK

Suica, PASMO, ICOCA and other Japanese IC cards work. Tap when you get on and off.

### Children

Ages 6–12 pay about half. Ages 1–5 ride free, one per paying passenger (pay if they use their own seat). From junior high, adult fare.

### No big luggage

One bag per person that fits on the rack or your lap. Only highway buses have a luggage hold. Leave suitcases in a locker first.

### Kawaguchiko Station lockers

Right outside the ticket gates.

700 S 1,000 M 1,200 L (¥)

Fujikyu Bus official FAQ, November 2026. Lockers confirmed by phone with Fujikyu call center, November 3, 2026.

*Loop Bus Times*

# Remember the last bus.

The loop buses stop early in the evening. The Blue Line runs only about once an hour, so plan backwards from your return time.

### Red Line · about every 15 min

| | First | Last |
|---|---|---|
| From Kawaguchiko Sta. | 9:00 | **17:45** |
| From Oishi Park | 9:27 | **18:27** |

Oishi Park → station about 27 min (last arrives 18:54)

### Green Line · every 30 min

| | First | Last |
|---|---|---|
| From Kawaguchiko Sta. | 9:10 | **16:40** |
| From Nenba | — | **17:40** |

Station → Nenba about 40 min, → Fugaku Wind Cave 49 min. Nenba → station about 35 min (last arrives 18:15)

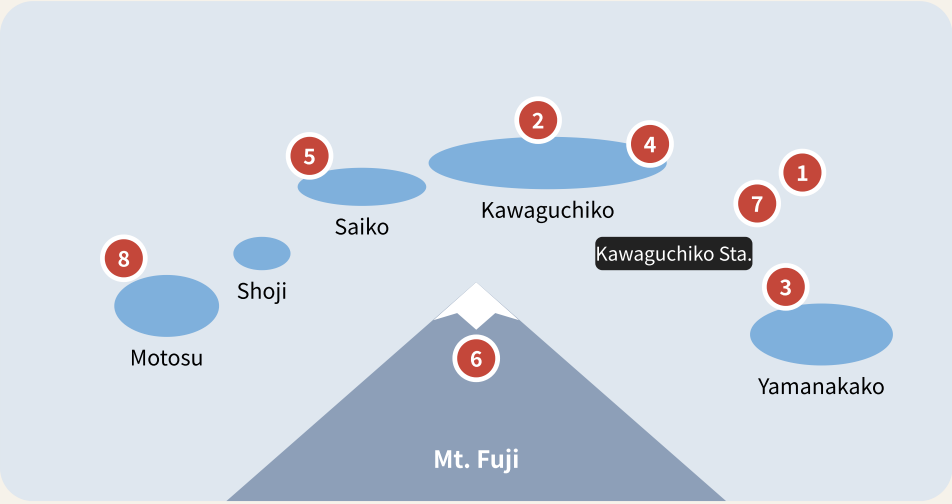
### Blue Line · about once an hour (with gaps)

| | First | Last |
|---|---|---|
| From Kawaguchiko Sta. | 9:35 | **15:35** |
| From Motosu Tourist Info Center | 10:45 | **16:45** |

From the station: Narusawa Ice Cave 28 min, Fugaku Wind Cave 39 min, Lake Motosu 57 min. Last bus from Motosu arrives 17:45.

Fujikyu Bus official timetable, November 2026.

# 8 places worth your time




Not to scale (illustration).

| | Place | Getting there | Time | Cost |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Chureito Pagoda | Shimoyoshida Sta. + 25 min walk | 1–1.5h | Free |
| 2 | Oishi Park | Red last stop | 1h | Free |
| 3 | Oshino Hakkai | Route bus | 1h | Free |
| 4 | Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway | Red 11 min | 1h | ¥1,200 |
| 5 | Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba | Green 40 min | 1–1.5h | ¥500 |
| 6 | Fuji Subaru Line 5th Station | Direct bus, 1h | 1.5–2h | Bus ¥2,000 |
| 7 | Fuji-Q Highland | Fujikyu Railway, 1 stop | half day+ | Entry free |
| 8 | Lake Motosu (¥1,000 bill view) | Blue 1h + 1h walk | about 3h | Free |

Adult prices. Ropeway = round trip; Fuji-Q rides cost extra.



NAVI

01

*The Iconic Shot — Fujiyoshida*

# Arakurayama Sengen Park (Chureito Pagoda)

The famous photo: a red five-story pagoda with Mt. Fuji behind it, framed by cherry blossoms in spring.

| From Shimoyoshida | Time needed | Entry | To the viewing deck |
|---|---|---|---|
| **25 min walk** | **1–1.5h** | **Free** | **398 steps** |
| incl. steps | | open 24 hours | |

## Best season *Best season*




Cherry blossoms around mid-April, autumn leaves around mid-November (approximate; changes every year). For Mt. Fuji, see the chart in Chapter 1.

## Light-up *Night*

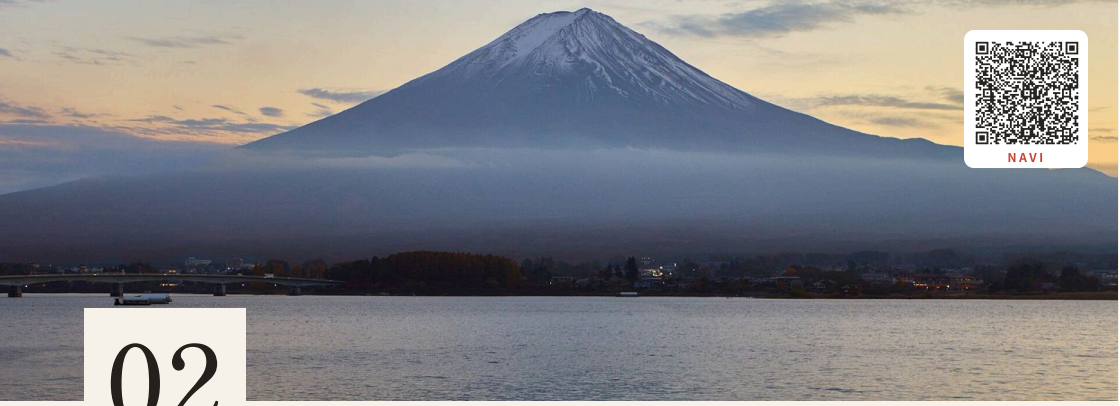
| Months | Lit |
|---|---|
| Jan–Feb · Dec | 16:00–21:50 |
| Mar–Apr · Oct–Nov | 17:00–21:50 |
| May | 18:00–21:50 |
| Jun–Sep | 19:00–21:50 |

May change.

INSIDER TIP

The park is very crowded with visitors, and the city asks people not to drive up to the plaza in front of the pagoda. **Walk from Shimoyoshida Station.** Toilets are in the park. The nearest car park (P1) costs ¥1,500 for up to 6 hours.

Fujiyoshida City Tourist Guide official, November 2026 / confirmed by phone with Fujiyoshida Tourism Promotion Service, November 3, 2026



NAVI

02

*Lake Kawaguchiko, North Shore*

# Lake Kawaguchiko North Shore (Oishi Park)

The classic view of Mt. Fuji across the lake. Flowers bloom from spring to autumn; the lavender is famous.

| Red Line last stop | Time needed | Park · parking | Open any time |
|---|---|---|---|
| Natural Living Center | 1 hour | Free | No closing days |

## Flower calendar *Flower calendar*




Nemophila mid-Apr–late May / roses late May–mid-Jun / lavender late Jun–mid-Jul / Casablanca lilies early–late Jul / kochia (green) early Aug–mid-Oct / kochia (red) early–late Oct. Dates change every year; the official website shows the flowers now.

### Facilities

Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center, "Oishiya" farm stand, gazebo, play equipment and a large car park. Wheelchair-accessible toilets inside the Center.

### Please note

There are no bins in the park: take your rubbish with you. Dogs must be on a leash.

*Oishi Park — Eat & Shop*

# Soft-serve, and a window facing Mt. Fuji.

### Oishi Park Café

12 soft-serve flavors. Blueberry and lavender are always on; the others change with the season.

**550** yen (all)

### Mt.Fuji View Cafe

Blueberry juice from local Oishi berries.

**800** yen

### ☆ 2F "Kitchen Fujiyama View"

Big windows facing Mt. Fuji. Cremia soft-serve, Fuji-shaped ice cream and roasted sweet potatoes (¥500). Souvenirs: Fuji goods, Yamanashi crafts and homemade blueberry jam.

As of November 2026. Prices and menus change. (Fujikawaguchiko Town Furusato Foundation official site, November 2026.)

## Natural Living Center hours *Hours*

| | Nov–Feb | Other months |
|---|---|---|
| Shop | 9:00–17:15 | — |
| Café · soft-serve | 9:15–16:15 | –16:45 |
| Kitchen Fujiyama View | 9:00–16:30 | –17:00 |

Open every day. Tel. 0555-76-8230. For shop hours outside Nov–Feb, check the official website.



Spring at Lake Kawaguchiko: cherry blossoms and Mt. Fuji.



NAVI

# 03

*Sacred Springs — Oshino*

## Oshino Hakkai

Eight ponds of crystal-clear spring water. Once a sacred site where pilgrims purified themselves before climbing Mt. Fuji.

### Where does the water come from? *How it works*

**Snow falls on Mt. Fuji**

↓

**It soaks into the ground and is filtered through lava for decades**

↓

**It springs up here**

### Recognition *Recognition*

| | |
|---|---|
| 1934 | Natural Monument of Japan |
| 1985 | Japan's 100 best waters |
| 2013 | Part of the Mt. Fuji World Heritage site |

Time needed
**1 hour**
on foot

¥
Cost
**Free**

### Getting there *Access*

| From | How | Time · frequency |
|---|---|---|
| **Kawaguchiko Sta. (first stop)** | Route bus A1/A2 (to Gotemba) or F1/F2 (to Yamanakako Hirano) | 1–2 an hour. First bus about 6:50 |
| **Kawaguchiko Sta.** | Express bus (about 10 min faster, about ¥200–300 more) | Hourly 9:40–16:40 (none at 12:40) |
| **Mt. Fuji Sta.** | Fujikyu route bus / "Fujikko-go" (Passport OK) | About 15–25 min |
| **Shinjuku** | Chuo Highway Bus to Fuji Five Lakes (beyond Fuji-Q) | About 2h20 in total |

Get off at "Oshino Hakkai". Oshino Village Tourism Association official, November 2026 / confirmed by phone with Oshino Tourist Information Center, November 3, 2026

# Busiest around lunchtime.




Quieter at other times. There is no gate and no opening hours, but there are few street lights, so walking around after dark is not recommended.

## Sokonuke Pond & Hannoki Bayashi Museum

Of the eight ponds, **Sokonuke Pond is inside the museum grounds** and can only be seen when it is open. The museum, on an old family estate, shows an 18th-century thatched farmhouse (one of the oldest at the foot of Mt. Fuji), Edo-period armor and swords, old farm tools and a 1582 document of the Hojo clan. Hoto and soba restaurant inside.

| Entry (tax incl., ¥) | Adult (junior high+) | Elementary | Age 1–preschool |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 300 | 150 | 100 |

Museum 9:00–17:00, restaurant 10:30–17:00 (closes early when food runs out). Irregular closing days (bad weather, family events). Groups of 15+: ¥50 off each. Tel. 0555-84-2587. (Hannoki Bayashi official, November 2026.)

### Wheelchairs

Free loan at the tourist information center (only 3; booking advised, 0555-84-4221). Most ponds are reachable, but not Okama Pond (steps) or Shobu Pond (rough path).

### Pets

OK on a leash. Carry them or use a cage inside shops.

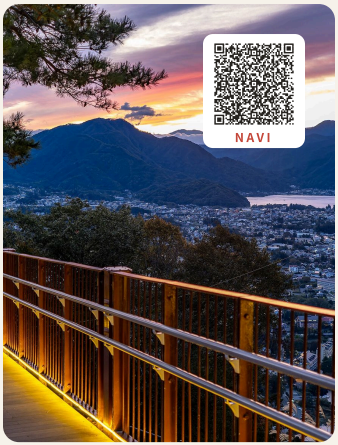
### Winter

Late November to March there is usually snow. Even without snow, shady spots can be icy.

### Rules

You may touch the water, but **never throw coins into the ponds.**

Tourist info center 0555-84-4222 (weekdays 9:00–17:00, weekends & holidays 9:00–16:00). Oshino Village Tourism Association official Q&A / confirmed by phone, November 3, 2026




# 04

*Mt. Tenjo*

## Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway (Mt. Tenjo)

From the lakeshore up the mountain. The top has wide views of Mt. Fuji and the lake.

| Red Line, 11 min | Time needed | Return adult/child | Usually |
|---|---|---|---|
| **15 min walk** | **1 hour** | **1,200／600** | **8:30–17:30** |
| "Yuransen · Ropeway Iriguchi" | | one way ¥800/400 | varies by season & maintenance |

Confirmed by phone with Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway, November 3, 2026




# 05

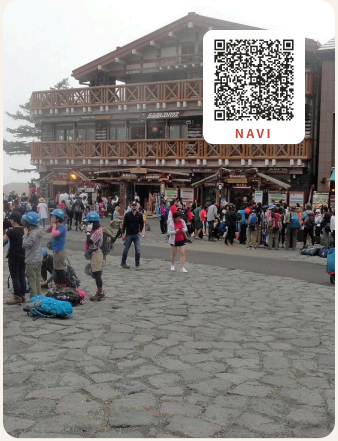
*Thatched Village*

## Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba

A re-created village of thatched-roof houses with Mt. Fuji behind it.

| Green Line, 40 min | Time needed | High school+ / 6–15 | Until November |
|---|---|---|---|
| **every 30 min** | **1–1.5h** | **500／250** | **9:00–17:00** |
| last from station 16:40 | | preschool free | Dec–Feb 9:30–16:30 |

Last entry 30 min before closing (16:30; winter 16:00). Confirmed by phone with Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba, November 3, 2026




# 06

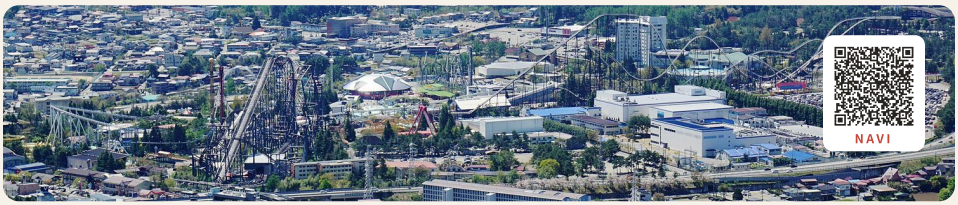
*Halfway up the Mountain*

## Fuji Subaru Line 5th Station

Ride a bus halfway up Mt. Fuji itself.

| Direct bus | Adult one way | Time needed |
|---|---|---|
| about 1 hour | 2,000 yen | 1.5–2h |

⚠ When Yamanashi Prefecture closes the Fuji Subaru Line (bad weather, snow, etc.), the buses don't run. **Check that the road is open before you go.** (Confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 3, 2026.)




*Theme Park*

# 07 Fuji-Q Highland

An amusement park at the foot of Mt. Fuji, famous for roller coasters. Fuji-Q Highland Station (one stop before Kawaguchiko); the Fuji Excursion and highway buses from Busta Shinjuku stop here too. Free entry; rides cost extra (single tickets or a pass). Half to a full day.

| Pass (price varies by day, ¥) | Adult 18–64 | Junior · senior high | Elementary | Preschool · 65+ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1-Day Pass | 6,000–7,900 | 5,500–7,400 | 4,400–5,100 | 2,100–2,600 |
| Afternoon Pass (from 13:00) | 4,100–6,000 | 3,800–5,700 | 3,500–4,200 | 1,700–2,100 |

Buy online or in the park; no refunds or changes. Some rides are not covered by passes. Hours change daily and there are closing days (e.g. January 2027: New Year 9:00–19:00, usually 10:00–17:00, closed Jan 13, 14, 20, 21, 27, 28). Closed for work: Ferris wheel (until Jan 31, 2027), "Tentekomai" (until late July 2027, planned), "Red Tower" (until further notice). **Check the monthly calendar on the official website before you go.** (Fuji-Q Highland official, November 2026.)



NAVI

# 08

*The 1,000-Yen View*

## Lake Motosu (the ¥1,000 bill view)

The view of Mt. Fuji printed on the back of the old ¥1,000 note. It's free, but by bus and on foot it takes about 3 hours.

### Plan carefully *Plan it like this*

**AM** — **Blue Line from Kawaguchiko Station to "Lake Motosu Tourist Information Center"**
About 1 hour · adult ¥1,470. About once an hour; last bus from the station 15:35.

**Walk about 1 hour to the viewpoint near Koansō**
If you get lost, show locals the name: 浩庵荘.

**15:30** — **Start walking back by now**
It's 1 hour on foot each way.

**16:45** — **Last bus from the Tourist Information Center**
Arrives at Kawaguchiko Station 17:45.

**Spring: Fuji Shibazakura Festival**

At Fuji Motosuko Resort near the lake: about 500,000 pink moss phlox in front of Mt. Fuji. In 2026, April 11–May 24 (changes every year with the flowers). Check dates and entry fee on the official website.

Bus stop, fare and walking time confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 2, 2026 / Fujikyu Bus official timetable / Fuji Motosuko Resort official, November 2026



CHAPTER

# 04

# Ready-Made Courses

All times assume you arrive at Kawaguchiko Station around 10:30 and leave around 17:00.

## COURSE A Relaxed day (first visit)

**10:30** — **Arrive at Kawaguchiko Station**
This course uses only the Red Line, so single tickets are cheaper than the 1-Day Pass (Chapter 2).

**11:00** — **Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway (④)**
Red Line, about 11 min

**12:30** — **Lunch: hoto near the station**
Chapter 5

**14:00** — **Red Line to Oishi Park (②)**
Soft-serve and Mt. Fuji across the lake.

**15:30** — **Bus back to the station · souvenirs**

**17:00** — **Train or bus back to Tokyo**
If you must be back by a set time, the train is safer.

COURSE B *For Photographers*

# A day for photographers

**7:30** — **Fuji Excursion 3 from Shinjuku**
Get off at Shimoyoshida.

**9:13** — **Arrive at Shimoyoshida**
Weekdays and weekends (Fujikyu Railway official timetable, from March 14, 2026).

**9:40** — **Chureito Pagoda (①)**
About 25 min on foot. Beat the tour buses.

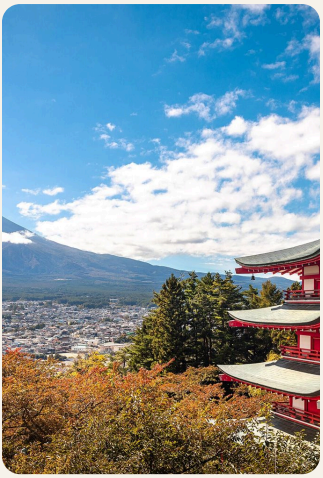
**12:00** — **Lunch: Yoshida udon**
Near Shimoyoshida (Chapter 5).

**13:30** — **Back to Kawaguchiko, then Oishi Park (②)**
Red Line

**14:45** — **Oishi Park → Kawaguchiko Station**
Red Line, about 27 min.

**15:40** — **Green Line to Nenba (⑤)**
Arrives 16:20. Last entry 16:30 — don't miss this bus.

**17:10** — **Green Line from Nenba to the station**
Arrives 17:45. Last bus from Nenba 17:40 (arrives 18:15).





☆ **Dec–Feb: Nenba's last entry is 16:00. Take the 15:10 bus instead (arrives about 15:50).**

**Ticket for this course**

You ride the Green Line, so the loop-bus 1-Day Pass (¥1,500) saves money.

COURSE C *Rainy Day*

# Rainy day: museums and a hot spring.

10:30 **Arrive at Kawaguchiko Station**

11:00 **Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum or Itchiku Kubota Art Museum**
Indoors. The Music Forest Museum is closed Tue & Wed.

13:00 **Lunch: hoto**

14:30 **Day-trip hot spring**
Yurari (no tattoos) or Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko (tattoos OK). Next page.

16:30 **Back to the station**

## Museums for a rainy day *Museums*



### Itchiku Kubota Art Museum

Kimono art by Itchiku Kubota. 10:00–17:00 (last entry 16:30). Closing days change monthly: see the official calendar. Red Line, adult ¥440 from the station.

| | |
|---|---|
| Adult | 1,500 |
| High school · university | 900 |
| Age 6–15 | 400 |



### Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum

European-style gardens and buildings, antique music boxes and self-playing instruments. 10:00–17:30 (last entry 17:00). Closed Tue & Wed; more closing days Jan–Mar. Red Line.

| | Weekday | Weekend |
|---|---|---|
| Adult | 1,800 | 2,100 |
| High school · university | 1,300 | 1,600 |
| Age 6–15 | 1,000 | 1,000 |

Prices in yen. Preschool children free (Music Forest). Entry, hours and closing days confirmed by phone with each museum, November 3, 2026.

*Hot Springs*

# Which day-trip hot spring?

It comes down to tattoos. With a tattoo, go to Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko — or a museum.

| | Fuji Choubou no Yu Yurari | Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko |
|---|---|---|
| **Tattoos** | **NO (even covered)** | **OK** |
| **What** | Day-trip hot spring with Mt. Fuji views (Narusawa, next to "Michi-no-Eki Narusawa" on the Blue Line) | Hotel bath, day use (2 hours) |
| **Adult** | Weekday **¥1,400**<br>Weekend/holiday ¥1,700 | With bath towel **¥1,850**<br>Without towel ¥1,000 |
| **Child** | Weekday ¥750 / weekend ¥800 (adult price from junior high) | With towel ¥1,650 / without ¥800 |
| **Hours** | Weekdays 10:00–21:00 (last entry 20:00). Weekends/holidays 1 hour longer (last entry 21:00) | 5:00–1:00 (next day). Closed 9:30–11:30 for cleaning |
| **Closed** | Only twice a year | Usually none |
| **Access** | **Free shuttle** from Kawaguchiko Station (book on the website; for the return, ask at the front desk) | About 18 min on foot from the station, or 8–9 min (¥180) by Red/Green Line. Hotel shuttle for overnight guests only |

Confirmed by phone with each facility, November 3, 2026. Walking time to Royal Hotel: Google Maps (November 2026).







*Chapter 05 · Local Food*

# Two local dishes.

## Hoto *Hoto*

Thick, flat wheat noodles simmered with pumpkin and vegetables in a miso soup, served bubbling in an iron pot. Perfect on a cold day.

Example: Hōtō Kura Fujinari (Kawaguchiko), signature "Golden Hōtō" (pork or chicken)

**1,815** yen

6931 Funatsu, Fujikawaguchiko. Restaurant's own menu on Google, November 2026.

**How to eat it**
It's very hot: scoop some into the small bowl and let it cool.

**Vegetarian?**
The soup may contain fish stock. Ask: "Dashi ni sakana wa haitte imasu ka?"

## Yoshida Udon *Yoshida Udon*

Fujiyoshida's local udon: very thick and very firm, in a soy-miso soup topped with cabbage and seasoned horse meat or beef.

Example: Miura Udon (near Shimoyoshida Station, handy after the pagoda). Most dishes up to about ¥900.

| | |
|---|---|
| Niku udon (most popular · horse meat & cabbage) | about ¥700 |
| Kaedama (extra noodles) | about ¥300 |

Menu listed on Google, November 2026. Prices may change.

## How to order *How to order*

1. Many places have a ticket machine at the entrance: pay first.
2. Hand the ticket to the staff. Pointing at the menu photo is fine.
3. No tipping in Japan.

# Good to know

## Beat the crowds *Beat the crowds*

**Arrive by 9–10 a.m.**
Tour buses arrive before noon.

**Pagoda first**
Before 9 a.m. if you can.

**Go on a weekday**
Much quieter than weekends and holidays.

## Photo manners *Respect the locals*

This area struggles with overtourism. Please, for the people who live here:

**Stay off the road**
Don't stand in the road or block cars for photos.

**No private property**
Don't enter private land or shops just for pictures.

**Quiet in residential areas**
People live here.

**Take your rubbish home**
Japan has very few public bins.

## Money, toilets, bags *Money, toilets, bags*

**Carry some cash**
IC cards work on the Fujikyu Railway and loop buses, but some small shops and restaurants are cash only.

**Toilets**
Free, clean toilets at stations, parks and convenience stores.

**Luggage**
Lockers right outside Kawaguchiko Station's ticket gates (S ¥700 · M ¥1,000 · L ¥1,200). Store bags before the loop buses.

Lockers confirmed by phone with Fujikyu call center, November 3, 2026.

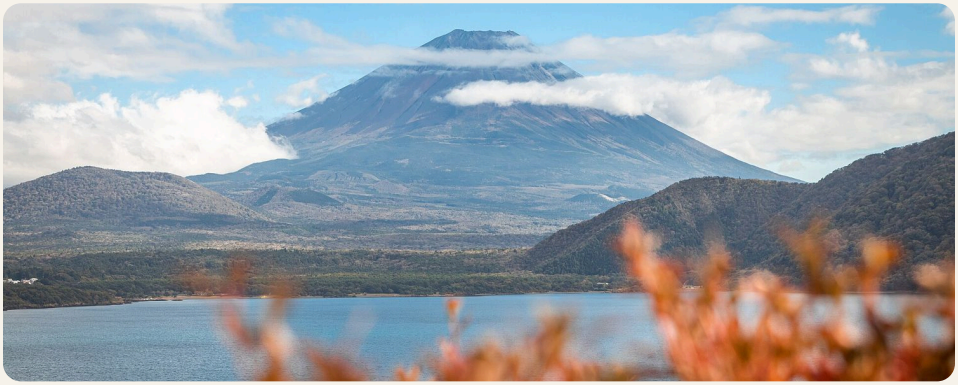
*Phrases & Checklist*

# Useful Japanese phrases

| English | Japanese (say this) | Pronunciation |
|---|---|---|
| Hello | こんにちは | Konnichiwa |
| Thank you | ありがとうございます | Arigatō gozaimasu |
| Excuse me | すみません | Sumimasen |
| Where is the toilet? | トイレはどこですか？ | Toire wa doko desu ka? |
| How much is this? | これはいくらですか？ | Kore wa ikura desu ka? |
| One ticket to Kawaguchiko, please | 河口湖まで1枚ください | Kawaguchiko made ichimai kudasai |
| Can I pay by card? | カードで払えますか？ | Kādo de haraemasu ka? |
| Is there fish in the broth? | 出汁に魚は入っていますか？ | Dashi ni sakana wa haitte imasu ka? |

## Packing checklist *Packing list*

- ☐ Train or bus tickets (book ahead)
- ☐ Some cash (some small shops are cash only)
- ☐ IC card (Suica · PASMO)
- ☐ A warm jacket
- ☐ Comfortable shoes (398 steps at the pagoda)
- ☐ Phone charger / power bank
- ☐ A small bag for rubbish
- ☐ Umbrella or raincoat



*Book & Navigate*

# Tickets & official websites

Scan a QR code with your phone camera to open the page. In the PDF you can also tap it.

**JR-EAST Train Reservation**
Book the Fuji Excursion in English
www.eki-net.com/en/jreast-train-reservation/

**Eki-net (JR East)**
Book the Fuji Excursion (Japanese)
www.eki-net.com/

**Highway Bus.com**
Book the highway bus from Busta Shinjuku
www.highwaybus.com/

**Fujikyu Railway**
Timetables, fares, Mt. FUJI Passport
www.fujikyu-railway.jp/

**Fujikyu Bus**
Sightseeing buses, timetables, bus passes
www.fujikyubus.co.jp/

**Fuji-Q Highland**
Ride passes and the opening calendar
www.fujiq.jp/

**Fuji Motosuko Resort**
Live camera and the Shibazakura Festival
www.fujimotosuko-resort.jp/

Highway buses can also be booked on FUJIYAMA CONNECT, Fujikyu's own booking site (search "FUJIYAMA CONNECT").

# Navigation: directions from where you are

Opens Google Maps with public-transport directions from where you are now.

**Kawaguchiko Station**
Open in Google Maps

**Busta Shinjuku (highway buses)**
Open in Google Maps

**① Chureito Pagoda**
Open in Google Maps

**② Oishi Park**
Open in Google Maps

**③ Oshino Hakkai**
Open in Google Maps

**④ Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway**
Open in Google Maps

**⑤ Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba**
Open in Google Maps

**⑥ Fuji Subaru Line 5th Station**
Open in Google Maps

**⑦ Fuji-Q Highland**
Open in Google Maps

**⑧ Lake Motosu viewpoint (Koansō)**
Open in Google Maps

**Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko (tattoos OK)**
Open in Google Maps

**Fuji Choubou no Yu Yurari**
Open in Google Maps

*Bonus · Quick Map*

# From Kawaguchiko Station, how do I get there?




TO TOKYO

Back to Tokyo (Shinjuku): Fuji Excursion or highway bus (Chapter 2).

Not to scale. Times are the checked information from Chapters 2 and 3.

*Credits*

# Photo credits

Photos from Wikimedia Commons, used under the licences shown (CC0 = no rights reserved; CC BY / CC BY-SA: creativecommons.org/licenses). Some photos are cropped; the destination sign and number plate on the highway bus photo are blurred.

| Used for | Photographer | Licence |
|---|---|---|
| Cover | Dang Son | CC0 |
| Place 1 · Course B | Supanut Arunoprayote | CC BY 4.0 |
| Chapter 1 · Place 2 | lumoplank | CC0 |
| Chapter 3 · Quick map | Midori | CC BY 3.0 |
| Place 3 | lumoplank | CC0 |
| Course finder · Place 4 · Course A | sergejf | CC BY 2.0 |
| Place 5 | sergejf | CC BY 2.0 |
| Place 6 | Fabio Achilli | CC BY 2.0 |
| Place 7 · Book & navigate | 663highland | CC BY-SA 4.0 |
| Know before you go · Place 8 | Supanut Arunoprayote | CC BY 4.0 |
| Chapter 2 | MaedaAkihiko | CC0 |
| Chapter 2 · Highway bus | Cassiopeia sweet | Public domain |
| Chapter 6 | Seloloving | CC BY 4.0 |
| Chapter 5 | GiveMeMollusks | CC0 |
| Chapter 5 | Ocdp | CC0 |
| Chapter 4 · Course C | 江戸村のとくぞう | CC BY-SA 4.0 |
| Course C | 江戸村のとくぞう | CC BY-SA 4.0 |

DISCLAIMER

This is an independent travel guide. It is not connected with any company or place in it. Prices, times and opening hours were checked in November 2026. Please check the official websites before you go.